

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/22: The control question and the three tiers

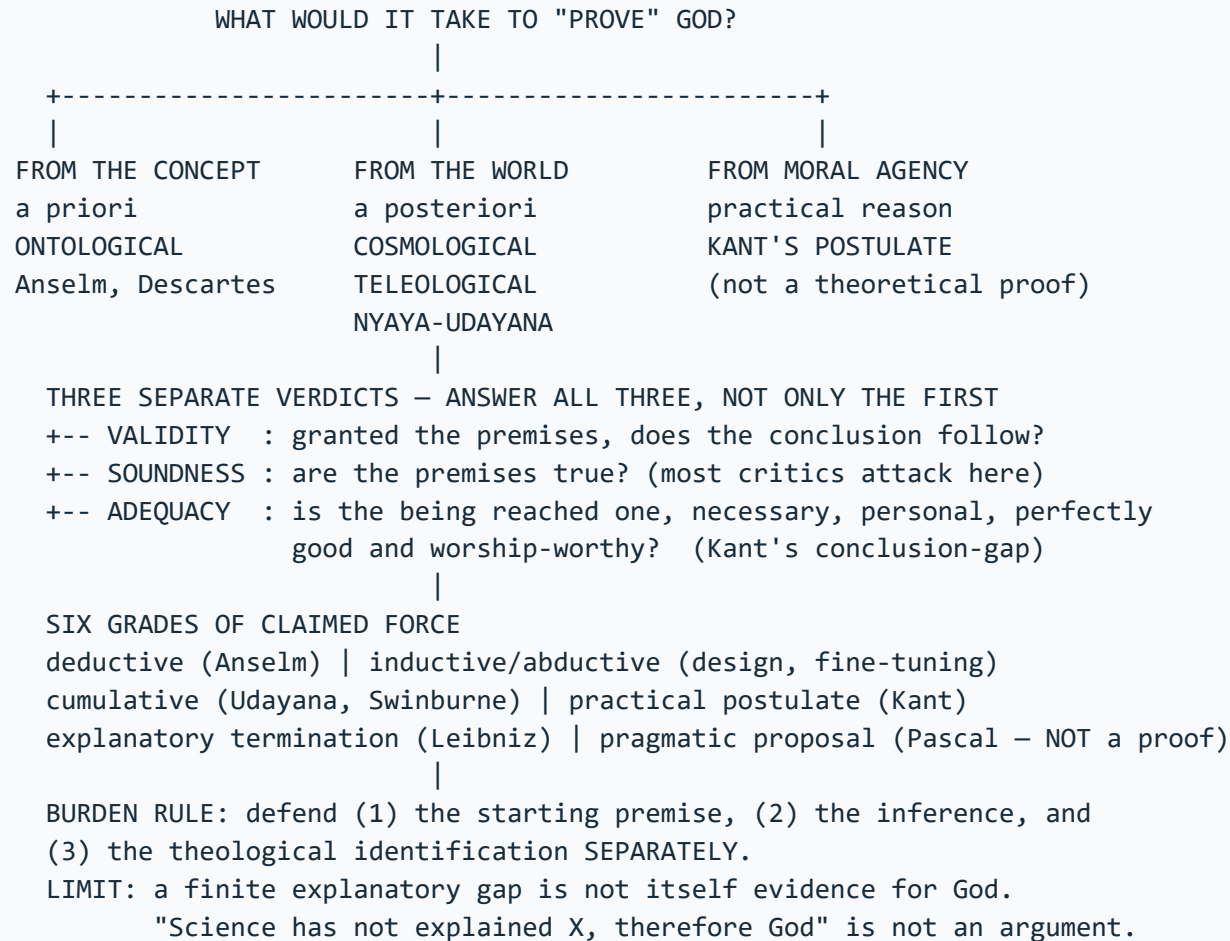
PHILOSOPHY PAPER II – PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION 03

PROOFS FOR THE EXISTENCE OF GOD AND THEIR CRITIQUE

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM – 13 PANELS

Syllabus, verbatim: "Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique (Indian and Western)."

Read top to bottom. Each panel is data-complete: premises, named critics, replies and verdict.



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/22: THE A PRIORI / A POSTERIORI DIVISION (2022 Q8(a), 20 marks)

	A PRIORI	A POSTERIORI
BASIS	concept of God alone	facts of the world
EXAMPLE	ontological only	cosmological, teleological, moral, Nyaya
STRENGTH	if valid, yields a NECESSARY God	begins from premises the critic concedes
WEAKNESS	Kant: existence is not a real predicate	reaches at best a probable, finite, possibly plural cause

CLASSIFICATION RULE: classify by the SOURCE OF THE PREMISES, never by the modality of the conclusion. Nyaya reaches an omniscient being and is still a posteriori; Aquinas' Fourth Way starts from OBSERVED degrees and is still a posteriori.

2022 VERDICT FORMULA: preference depends on the criterion named –
evidential contact -> a posteriori
modal strength -> a priori
religious adequacy -> neither alone.

ANSELM, Proslogion 2 (1077-78) – a REDUCTION

ASSUME: God exists in the understanding ALONE

P1: God =def "that than which nothing greater can be conceived"

(aliquid quo nihil maius cogitari possit); "greater" = MORE PERFECT

P2: existing in reality is greater than existing in the mind alone

=> a greater than God could be conceived – contradicts P1

∴ the assumption is false; God exists in reality

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ANSELM, Proslogion 3 – THE PHILOSOPHICALLY SERIOUS FORM

a being that CANNOT be thought not to exist is greater

∴ God exists NECESSARILY – core notion: self-existence (aseity)

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DESCARTES, Meditations V (1641): existence belongs to the essence of a

supremely perfect being as three angles to a triangle, a valley to a mountain

NOT to be fused with Meditations III's CAUSAL proof from the idea of the infinite

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/22: Ontological argument II: Gaunilo, Kant, the modal repair and the Indian absence

OBJECTION 1 – GAUNILLO, "Is There a Being More Perfect than God?" parody

precision point: he wrote "most perfect OF islands", not "most perfect CONCEIVABLE island" – correcting this strengthens the parody

ANSELM'S REPLY: an island is a contingent piece of the physical world and can be thought not to exist; only God is defined with necessary existence

RESIDUE: protects form 2, exposes form 1, and shifts the burden to whether maximal greatness is COHERENT (islands have no intrinsic maximum)

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OBJECTION 2 – KANT: "existence is not a real predicate" (CPR A598/B626 region)

100 real thalers contain not one coin more than 100 possible thalers

Chatterjee-Datta's Indian idiom: 100 rupees imagined in the pocket

∴ nothing can be defined into existence; only a CONDITIONAL follows

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OBJECTION 3 – post-Fregean logic: "exists" is a second-order quantificational notion; it cannot appear in a list of perfections at all

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REPLY – MODAL VERSIONS (Malcolm, Hartshorne, Plantinga)

1 possibly a maximally great being exists

2 maximal greatness = necessary existence + maximal excellence in every world

3 if possible, it exists in some possible world

4 what exists necessarily in some world exists in every world

∴ it exists in the actual world

BURDEN MIGRATES to premise 1 - the POSSIBILITY PREMISE; "possibly no such being" yields the contrary conclusion by the same modal logic

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INDIAN NOTE: no classical Indian analogue. Reason is pramana-theoretic –

Nyaya's means of knowledge are world-involving and inference needs vyapti (invariable concomitance) fixed by observation; Advaita reaches Brahman by scripture plus experience, not by concept-analysis.

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2018 VERDICT: the concept entails existence CONDITIONALLY (if God exists, God exists necessarily) – conceptual entailment, never instantiation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/22: Cosmological family – three forms that must not be merged

FORM	STARTING POINT	TERMINUS	PRESSURE
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AQUINAS Ways 1-3 (ST I q.2 a.3)	present change, ordered efficient causation, contingency	unmoved actualiser, first efficient cause, necessary being	needs an ESSENTIALLY ordered series
LEIBNIZ	the contingent totality + principle of sufficient reason	a necessary sufficient reason outside the series	the principle may be denied; brute fact allowed
KALAM (temporal beginning)	whatever begins has a cause; the universe began	a cause of the beginning separate defence	beginning premise + personhood need

THE DISTINCTION THE WHOLE ARGUMENT TURNS ON

ESSENTIALLY ORDERED (per se): hand -> stick -> stone. Members act
SIMULTANEOUSLY; intermediates have only DERIVATIVE power; remove the hand
and the series stops NOW. This is the series Aquinas terminates.

ACCIDENTALLY ORDERED (per accidens): grandfather -> father -> son. Each
member has power in its own right and may perish. Aquinas need NOT stop it.

∴ "FIRST" = EXPLANATORY priority here and now, NOT the earliest event.

Aquinas holds a temporal beginning is known by FAITH, not demonstration.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/22: Cosmological family II: the Five Ways mapped, and the critics

THE FIVE WAYS, MAPPED

Way 1 motion/change -> unmoved mover (cosmological)

Way 2 ordered efficient causes -> first cause (cosmological)

Way 3 contingency -> necessary being (cosmological)

Way 4 observed degrees -> maximum/source (henological)

Way 5 regular directedness -> intelligence (teleological)

Each closes "and this everyone understands to be God."

Way 3's weak steps: the quantifier shift at "at some time nothing existed",
and necessary-through-another (ab alio) vs necessary-of-itself (a se).

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CRITICS

HUME : why not an infinite series? explaining each part may explain the whole; the cause need not be one, personal, infinite or good

RUSSELL : the universe is "just there" – a brute fact; composition fallacy

KANT : the passage from "a necessary being" to "the most real being" is the ONTOLOGICAL argument in disguise – an ADEQUACY objection

REPLY : the argument concerns DEPENDENCE, not property-transfer; but allowing a brute totality REJECTS sufficient reason rather than refuting the argument.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/22: TELEOLOGICAL ARGUMENT (2025 Q6(a), 20 marks – with Hume)

THREE TELEOLOGIES THAT MUST NOT BE CONFUSED

- [1] AQUINAS Way 5 : regular directedness of NON-COGNITIVE nature.
Archer and arrow. A GOVERNANCE argument, not an artefact analogy.
- [2] PALEY (1802) : ANALOGY from artefact to organism. Watch on a heath – wheels, cogs, axles, springs, balances adjusted for regular timekeeping; a stone is not. Three riders: the inference survives (i) never having seen a watch made, (ii) imperfect working, (iii) parts whose function we cannot discover. Cumulative evidence: eye as self-adjusting optical instrument, bird's wing, fish's fin, planetary rotation, the seasons.
- [3] FINE-TUNING : probabilistic/abductive, pre-biological, about constants.

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CHRONOLOGY TRAP: Hume's Dialogues (published 1779) PRECEDE Paley (1802).

Philo – not Cleanthes – carries the objections.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/22: Teleological argument II: Hume, Darwin and fine-tuning

HUME'S FIVE FRONTS (probably A-A-P-B-E)

- A ADAPTED : any persisting universe must look adapted; there could not be birds with wings unable to live in air. EPICUREAN HYPOTHESIS: finite particles in random motion pass through every combination in unlimited time; one is a stable order.
 - A ANALOGY : the universe resembles a vegetable or a crustacean at least as much as a machine; only STRONG analogy licenses inference.
 - P PROPORTION : proportion cause to effect – from a finite world one can never infer an infinite creator (the scales illustration).
 - P PLURALITY : many designers, an inferior deity, an infant or senile one, or an abandoned first attempt fit the evidence equally.
 - E EVIL : disorder and suffering count against a good, powerful maker.
- LIMIT: Hume does NOT disprove a designer. He attacks inference-strength and the attributes of the conclusion.

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DARWIN (1859): random variation + differential survival explains adaptation.
Ozone illustration: life fitted itself to the filter, not the filter to life.
EXACT SCOPE: defeats Paley's BIOLOGICAL premise. Does NOT touch cosmic law-governedness or the fine-tuning of constants.

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FINE-TUNING'S LIVE RIVALS

- +-- design
 - +-- physical necessity
 - +-- chance / multiverse + observation-selection effect
 - +-- an unknown deeper law
- VERDICT: probabilistic inference to the best explanation, never demonstration.

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INDIAN ANALOGUE: ayojanat – the pot-and-potter inference. Chatterjee-Datta note parallels in Janet, Lotze and Martineau, but stress the divergence: Western theists make God the source of EXISTENCE; Nyaya makes God the cause of ORDER only.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/22: MORAL ARGUMENT (2021 Q7(b), 15 marks)

THREE ROUTES – DO NOT MERGE THEM

ROUTE 1 MORAL LAW / CONSCIENCE (Newman, Grammar of Assent)

binding duty and shame imply One before whom we are responsible

OBJECTION: moral psychology and social life may explain conscience

HICK: the route assumes values resist naturalistic explanation – it BEGS the question. Force: an inference to agency, not a demonstration.

ROUTE 2 OBJECTIVE VALUE AND DUTY

stance-independent moral truths require a transcendent ground

OBJECTION: moral realism need not be theistic; EUTHYPHRO presses the grounding – good because willed, or willed because good?

Force: at most an abductive grounding argument.

ROUTE 3 KANT'S HIGHEST GOOD (Critique of Practical Reason, 1788)

KANT'S TWO STOREYS: CPR (1781/87) DESTROYS the ontological, cosmological and physico-theological proofs; CPrR REINSTATES God as a POSTULATE.

1 the moral law obligates pursuit of the highest good (summum bonum: virtue with proportionate happiness)

2 finite agents cannot secure that proportion; nature does not supply it

3 "ought implies can" licenses postulating its conditions

4 THREE POSTULATES: FREEDOM, IMMORTALITY, GOD

A postulate is practically necessary and theoretically undemonstrable – rational faith (Vernunftglaube): subjectively sufficient, objectively insufficient assent.

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EUTHYPHRO'S TARGET: divine-command and value-grounding routes – NOT Kant.

For Kant the moral law is AUTONOMOUS; God guarantees PROPORTION, not obligation.

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OBJECTIONS: projection / wish-fulfilment; autonomy tension; adequacy.

HICK'S VERDICT: moral seriousness is "at least a move in the direction of belief in God", but values cannot be said to point all the way to the infinite, omnipotent, self-existent personal creator.

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INDIAN COUNTERPART: Nyaya's fruit-giver (karmaphaladata).

KEY CONTRAST: Kant POSTULATES a God who COULD proportion virtue and happiness;

Nyaya INFERS a God who DOES – epistemically bolder, correspondingly more exposed.

NATURE OF ISVARA

first EFFICIENT cause – a builder, NEVER the material cause
also preserver (the world is kept in existence by God's will) and destroyer
one, infinite, eternal, omniscient; possesses the six perfections (sad-aisvarya)
the world relates to God as a body to the self residing in it
omnipotent YET GUIDED by the merit and demerit of human actions
eternal intelligence is an INSEPARABLE ATTRIBUTE of God, not His essence

(the explicit contrast with Advaita)

THEISM, NOT DEISM: the deist's God withdraws like a clockmaker; Nyaya's God
maintains a continuous relation as creator, maintainer and destroyer
God is prayojaka karta – efficient DIRECTIVE cause of human action; man is
the efficient INSTRUMENTAL cause, relatively free, directed as a wise father
directs a son

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/22: Nyaya-Udayana theism II: Udayana's eight collected grounds

UDAYANA, NYAYAKUSUMANJALI, 5th c. CE, 11th c. – THE COLLECTED GROUNDS

(a mnemonic verse conventionally unpacked as EIGHT hetus; glosses of the last four VARY – give the Sanskrit term plus one clause, and say that they vary)

- 1 KARYAT the composite world is an EFFECT; every effect presupposes an intelligent maker who knows its material, means and end. Composites are effects because they are made of parts (savayava) and have intermediate magnitude (avantara-mahattva); space, time, ether and self are excluded as partless infinities, atoms and manas as simple infinitesimals. The maker must be OMNISCIENT, since only an omniscient being can directly know atoms.
- 2 AYOJANAT inert atoms cannot combine themselves; the initial conjunction (samyoga) requires a conscious agent's volition
- 3 DHRTYADEH support, sustenance and periodic dissolution require a governing will ("adi" carries the maintenance/destruction pair)
- 4 PADAT transmission of language, arts and crafts presupposes an original competent teacher
- 5 PRATYAYATAH the VALIDITY (pramanya) of the Veda requires a trustworthy (apta) author, as a science's authority derives from its founder; the jiva cannot be that author
- 6 SRUTEH the Veda's own testimony to Isvara counts as evidence within the system (Brhadaranyaka, Svetasvatara, Kausitaki, Gita)
- 7 VAKYAT the Veda consists of SENTENCES, and sentences are of the kind produced by persons – hence a personal author
- 8 SAMKHYAVISESAT the "special number": the dyad (dvyanuka) that begins creation requires the numerical cognition (apeksa-buddhi) of a conscious being present at the start, when no finite self is embodied [technically the hardest – state it only if stated correctly]

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/22: Nyaya-Udayana theism III: adrsta, internal answers and external pressure

THE ARGUMENT FROM ADRSTA – the philosophical core, running beneath all right

differences of lot require a cause -> karma -> the time-gap requires a persisting stock of merit and demerit (punya/papa = ADRSTA) -> adrsta is UNCONSCIOUS and cannot allot the right kind and degree of joy and sorrow; individual selves neither know nor control it
∴ an eternal, omniscient dispenser – karmadhyaksa / karmaphaladata

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TWO OBJECTIONS ANSWERED INSIDE THE SYSTEM

CIRCULARITY : in the ORDER OF EXISTENCE God creates the Veda; in the ORDER OF KNOWLEDGE the Veda leads to God. Reciprocal dependence across DIFFERENT orders is not a vicious circle.

BODILESS AGENT : a dilemma – if God's existence is already established by scripture the objection is idle; if not, it presupposes what it disputes.

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EXTERNAL PRESSURE

SANKARA'S ATOMISM DILEMMA: atoms active -> permanent creation; inactive -> no creation; both -> contradiction; neither -> an outside agency, itself problematic. Advaita grants Isvara only empirical (vyavaharika) standing.

SAMKHYA: unconscious nature (prakrti) evolves without a creator.

REDUNDANCY CHARGE (C. D. Sharma): Nyaya's God is "reduced to the status of a supervisor" with "hands and feet chained by the shackles of the Law of Karma unfolding itself as the Adrsta"; the system "could have easily done away with a God". This is Nyaya's hardest challenge.

CHATTERJEE-DATTA'S OWN CONCLUSION: no proof can prove God, because God as ultimate reality is the highest of all premises and cannot be deduced from an anterior one; God must be known through DIRECT EXPERIENCE.

Lotze: "all proofs that God exists are pleas put forward in justification of our faith."

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/22: Two senses of "god" in the indian debate

SENSE A – WORLD MAKER (jagat-karta / Isvara-karta-vada)

the cosmological office: creates or arranges, sustains, dissolves, allots

AFFIRMED by: Nyaya-Vaisesika, theistic Vedanta, Yoga (as a special self)

DENIED by: Jainism, Buddhism, Mimamsa, Carvaka, classical Samkhya

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SENSE B – PERFECTED / OMNISCIENT BEING (achieved divinity)

the soteriological office: omniscient, passion-free, exemplary, non-creative

AFFIRMED by: Jainism (arihanta, tirthankara, siddha), Buddhism (buddhas,

celestial bodhisattvas), and by devotional traditions generally

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THE RULE THAT SAVES THE ANSWER

"Denying a creator is not denying divinity."

A school may deny Sense A completely and affirm Sense B completely.

Nastika means denier of VEDIC AUTHORITY, not denier of spirit.

Buddhism denies a CREATOR, not devas – who are long-lived, impermanent beings inside the round of rebirth.

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CONSEQUENCE FOR THE 2019 AND 2018 STEMS: a stem that asks for "the proofs propounded in Jainism" or for "arguments against God as creator" is asking about SENSE A. Answer in Sense A, then supply Sense B as what the school affirms instead.

READ THE STEM EXACTLY. The Jain propounds NO proof of a creator. It propounds

(a) a battery of arguments AGAINST one, and (b) divinity as achieved perfection.

A script that invents Jain theistic proofs loses the paper; a script that says only "Jainism is atheistic" loses half the marks.

THE WORLD: uncreated, beginningless, eternal; six substances (jiva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, akasa, kala); reality is origination, decay and permanence (utpada-vyaya-dhrauvya); change belongs to MODES, not to a divine act.

SIX ARGUMENTS AGAINST A CREATOR

- 1 MOTIVE (the strongest, and the one examiners want)
a perfect being is complete – without unfulfilled desire, deficiency or need
creation is an ACTION, and every action presupposes a want or purpose
∴ either God is perfect and had no motive, or God had a motive and is not perfect
- 2 REGRESS if everything needs a maker, the maker needs a maker; if the maker can be uncaused, so can the world – the premise self-defeats
- 3 INSTRUMENT before creation there was no matter, no space, no body, no instrument; an immaterial God with nothing to work on cannot act
- 4 MORAL creation from compassion is refuted by suffering, inequality and predation; creation without compassion is not good; creation as sport is childish and cruel. Karma explains the DISTRIBUTION of fortune without impugning anyone's goodness
- 5 REDUNDANCY karmic matter, the six substances and causal law already explain order, bondage and release – the parsimony (laghava) move
- 6 SVABHAVVA things act by their own nature: fire burns, water flows (assembled in Jinasena's Mahapurana and in Hemacandra; also Haribhadra, Akalanka, Vidyanandi)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 15/22: Jaina critique II: achieved divinity, objections and verdict

WHAT JAINISM AFFIRMS INSTEAD – DO NOT BLUR THESE

ARIHANTA / KEVALIN : destroyed the four obscuring (ghatiya) karmas and attained omniscience (kevala-jnana) WHILE STILL EMBODIED

TIRTHANKARA : a special arihanta who RE-ESTABLISHES the fourfold order (monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen) and preaches the path. 24 in each half-cycle; Mahavira is the 24th of the present. Defined by a TEACHING-AND-FOUNDING function, not by rank.

SIDDHA : has additionally shed the four non-obscuring (aghatiya) karmas at death; DISEMBODIED, at the siddhasila at the summit of the cosmos, with the four infinitudes (ananta-catustaya: infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy)

∴ EVERY TIRTHANKARA BECOMES A SIDDHA; NOT EVERY SIDDHA WAS A TIRTHANKARA.

Neither creates, sustains, judges nor answers prayer. The tirthankara is passion-free (vitaraga), so worship is COMMEMORATIVE and ASPIRATIONAL – the object does not respond, and cannot, since responsiveness would be a passion. The five-fold salutation (arihanta, siddha, acarya, upadhyaya, sadhu) salutes QUALITIES AND STAGES, not a deity.

Every jiva intrinsically possesses the four infinitudes, obscured not absent; "we are all potential Jinas" – a religion of self-help.

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OBJECTION -> REPLY

NYAYA : unconscious karmic matter cannot allot determinate fruits to determinate persons, nor can inert atoms self-organise

JAIN REPLY: karmic influx and maturation are LAW-LIKE properties of the jiva-matter relation, exactly as poison acts without a poisoner supervising it

COUNTER : "God has no motive" assumes creation must be motivated as HUMAN action is; classical theism replies that creation is a free, non-needy diffusion of goodness (bonum diffusivum sui), not the satisfaction of a lack. THIS EXCHANGE IS THE HIGHEST-YIELD PARAGRAPH IN THE ANSWER.

INTERNAL : Sharma – if ignorance and karma are inseparable from the soul, liberation is impossible; if external, bondage is impossible.

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VERDICT: Jainism supplies no proof OF God; it supplies a proof-structure AGAINST a creator and a redefinition of divinity as the soul's achieved perfection. Its motive argument is powerful against an anthropomorphic creator and weaker against a classical theism that denies creation is need-driven.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 16/22: BUDDHIST CRITIQUE – THREE STRATA (2018 Q8(b), 15 marks)

STRATUM (a) – CANONICAL / GENETIC

BRAHMAJALA SUTTA (DN 1): the being first reborn in an empty Brahma-world, seeing others appear after his wish, concludes "I am Brahma, the Maker, the Creator"; later arrivals remember him and transmit the error

AGGANNA SUTTA (DN 27): a naturalistic-cyclic account of cosmic and social evolution replaces creation

AVYAKATA (undeclared questions) + the poisoned-arrow parable: speculative cosmogony is soteriologically idle

HONEST LIMIT: these DIAGNOSE the belief; they do not REFUTE the proposition.

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STRATUM (b) – CAUSAL-METAPHYSICAL [Dharmakirti; Santaraksita's Tattvasamgraha with Kamalasila's Panjika] – THIS IS WHERE THE EXAMINABLE ARGUMENT LIES

- 1 CRITERION OF EXISTENCE: to be real is to be causally efficacious (arthakriya-karitva)
- 2 THE SUCCESSIVE-OR-SIMULTANEOUS DILEMMA (krama-akrama-virodha):
 - a PERMANENT, UNCHANGING cause must produce its effects either ALL AT ONCE -> the whole cosmos arises in one instant and nothing follows or SUCCESSIVELY -> God acquires at t2 an auxiliary he lacked at t1, and is therefore neither permanent nor self-sufficient
- 3 AUXILIARY REGRESS: if God needs auxiliaries (material, karma, time) he is not the SOLE cause; if he does not, the world's temporal order is unexplained
- 4 EVIDENTIAL: the inference "effect -> intelligent maker" rests on a vyapti established only for ARTEFACTS; generalising it is the very point at issue
- 5 REDUNDANCY: conditioned co-arising (pratityasamutpada) already accounts for arising and cessation – a creator is an idle wheel

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 17/22: Buddhist critique II: moral stratum, distinction, replies and verdict

STRATUM (s) – MORAL

a being able to create who ordered THIS quantity of suffering is either not benevolent or not omnipotent; and if all is God's will, karma and moral effort are pointless. DEVADAHA SUTTA (MN 101) makes the parallel point against determinism generally: a doctrine that makes present effort ineffective destroys the moral life.

[Bhuridatta Jataka anti-creator verses: widely cited, wording translation-dependent – PARAPHRASE ONLY.]

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DISTINCTION: Buddhism is NON-THEISTIC, not merely atheistic. It rejects a CREATOR (isvara-karana-vada), not every divine being; devas are impermanent beings within the round of rebirth, and later Buddha-fields and celestial bodhisattvas perform religious functions without an omnipotent creator.

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OBJECTION -> REPLY

NYAYA : God's WILLING is eternal while its EFFECTS are timed by the readiness of adrsta, so no change in God is required; and to demand PERCEPTION of God begs the question against inference

BUDDHIST : an eternal will whose efficacy is timed by something else is not the sole and sufficient cause the theist claimed

SECOND : if there is no self and no creator, what carries karma?
-> routed to Topic 04, Soul, Immortality, Rebirth and Liberation

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VERDICT: strongest where METAPHYSICAL – the permanence/production dilemma bites on any UNCHANGING creator – and weakest where merely GENETIC, since explaining why people believe in Brahma does not show there is none.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 18/22: Mimamsa and carvaka – the remaining two denials

MIMAMSA – displaces God twice over

APAURUSEYA : the Veda is eternal, AUTHORLESS and self-valid; no human and NO DIVINE author is needed. Authorlessness protects it from an author's deceit or ignorance. Against Nyaya: proving God, then His omniscience, then His truthfulness, is a cumbersome three-stage dependence that authorlessness avoids.

-> the exact contradictory of Udayana's padat / pratyayatah / sruteh / vakyat

APURVA : the unseen potency of a correctly performed ritual matures into future fruit WITHOUT a divine dispenser; Prabhakara's niyoga grounds obligation in the injunction itself

-> the exact contradictory of the adrsta / karmadhyaksa argument

Word-meaning relation is intrinsic (autpattika), not conventionally instituted by a person – removing the last need for a divine institutor of language
Chatterjee-Datta record Max Muller's points that a creator God faces charges of cruelty and partiality, and that denying a CREATOR is not denying God
THEIR CRITICISM: Mimamsa deities are not objects of worship and exist only in the mantras describing them – "eternal and self-manifesting concepts"; God is relegated to an ambiguous position

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CARVAKA – cuts the ground from every inferential proof

only perception is a means of valid knowledge; inference cannot reach the supersensible; the world is made by the automatic combination of the material elements; Vedas and priests are rejected

-> if this stands, EVERY anumana-based proof, Indian or Western, fails at once

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ADVAITA'S LEVELLING (not a denial, a demotion)

Nyaya's God is a qualified Lord (saguna Isvara) at the empirical (vyavaharika) level, not the quality-transcending absolute (nirguna Brahman); the atomistic proof is judged logically weak

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NYAYA'S STANDING REPLIES

unconscious merit cannot intelligently allot determinate fruits

authorless normativity is itself unexplained

demanding perception of God begs the question against inference

the pot/cosmos dissimilarity affects the STRENGTH, not the FORM, of the inference

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CLASSIFICATION KEY – every Indian anti-creator argument is one of three moves:

ECONOMY (redundancy/laghava) | COHERENCE (motive, krama-akrama) |

EPISTEMIC RESTRICTION (Carvaka on inference; Mimamsa on scriptural self-validity)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 19/22: Cumulative-case logic and the comparative bench

~~C-INDUCTIVE : premises RAISE the probability of the conclusion~~

$P(\text{theism} \mid e) > P(\text{theism})$, but not necessarily > 0.5

| several INDEPENDENT strands

v

P-INDUCTIVE : premises make the conclusion MORE PROBABLE THAN NOT (> 0.5)

[Swinburne, The Existence of God; Mitchell, The Justification of Religious Belief]

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IMAGES: CHAIN (wrong – the components are not deductions, so no link breaks)

ROPE (right – many strands, none end to end, jointly load-bearing)

JURY (Mitchell – converging circumstantial evidence, none sufficient alone)

NOT THE SAME AS inference to the best explanation, which compares rival TOTAL hypotheses rather than accumulating confirmation.

SWINBURNE'S PRIOR: SIMPLICITY – one agent with infinite (hence non-arbitrary) degrees of power, knowledge and freedom is simpler than any finite alternative.

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FLEW, God and Philosophy: TEN LEAKY BUCKETS – buckets that each leak hold no more water when stacked; zero plus zero is zero.

REPLY: correct only if each argument had NO force; a C-inductive argument has some by definition. Rope, not stacked buckets.

RESIDUAL OBJECTIONS: (i) underdetermination – a finite designer, a committee of gods or an impersonal value-principle fit equally; simplicity is the proposed selector and is itself contested; (ii) the case must be run as a NET balance, with suffering counted on the other side.

UDAYANA'S 8-FOLD COLLECTION IS STRUCTURALLY THE SAME MOVE, EIGHT CENTURIES

EARLIER – and Flew's objection applies to both equally.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 20/22: Comparative parity bench: convergence and divergence

FUNCTION	WESTERN	INDIAN PRO-THEISTIC	INDIAN ANTI-THEISTIC
effect -> maker	Aquinas Way 2; Paley	Nyaya karyat, ayojanat	Buddhist attack on the vyapti; Jain regress
order/governance	Aquinas Way 5	Udayana dhrtiyadeh	Jain svabhava; Samkhya's unconscious prakrti
scripture's authority	revealed theology	Udayana pratyayatah, sruteh, vakyat	Mimamsa's apauruseya Veda – authority without an author
moral order	Kant's postulate	Isvara as karmadhyaksa	karma/apurva as self-fructifying
from concept alone	Anselm, Descartes	no close classical analogue	–
aggregation	Swinburne's cumulative case	Udayana's eight-fold stabaka	Flew's leaky buckets applies to both

CONVERGENCE / DIVERGENCE

CONVERGE: both traditions build a posteriori inferences from order to intelligence

DIVERGE : Aquinas' God causes BEING; Nyaya's Isvara causes only ORDER

creation from nothing vs the arrangement of ETERNAL atoms

Nyaya makes God the Veda's author; Mimamsa makes the Veda authorless –
there is NO Western analogue for that position

India's sharpest critics stood INSIDE orthodoxy (Mimamsa, Samkhya);
the West's stood outside it

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 21/22: Verdict ladder, traps and the answer spine

FOUR DEFENSIBLE VERDICTS – CHOOSE ONE, NAME THE CRITERION, PAY ITS COST

- V1 MINIMAL no proof is demonstrative; each fails on validity, soundness or adequacy (Chatterjee-Datta, following Kant and Lotze)
- V2 CUMULATIVE individually weak, jointly they raise probability (Udayana; Swinburne; Mitchell)
- V3 DIVERGENT different proofs establish different things – necessity, agency, intelligence, moral government – and no single one was ever meant to deliver the whole God of religion
- V4 EXPERIENTIAL proofs are "pleas put forward in justification of our faith" (Lotze); God is known through direct experience

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GRADED BAND LADDER

- WEAK ~40% names four Western proofs and "Nyaya's inference"; narrates the watch
- AVG ~50% one proof reconstructed with a standard critique attached
- GOOD ~60% premises numbered; presupposition named; one objection answered
- STRONG 65-70 validity/soundness/adequacy separated; Indian parallel ARGUED; the proponent's reply supplied
- TOP 70%+ all the above + one discriminating distinction (per se vs per accidens; C- vs P-inductive; tirthankara vs siddha; krama-akrama) + a statement of what evidence would change the verdict

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TWELVE MASTER TRAPS

- 1 do not merge the Five Ways into one temporal "first cause" argument
- 2 the watch is PALEY'S (1802), never Aquinas'
- 3 Kant POSTULATES God for practical reason; he does not prove God by morality
- 4 Nyaya's God is the EFFICIENT, never the MATERIAL, cause; atoms are eternal
- 5 Hume attacks inference-strength and attributes; he does not disprove a designer
- 6 distinguish a proof's VALIDITY from the ADEQUACY of the God it establishes
- 7 never omit Anselm's second form; the reply to Gaunilo depends on it
- 8 modal versions carry a POSSIBILITY-PREMISE burden; they do not defeat Kant cleanly
- 9 Mimamsa's Veda is apauruseya and karma can be self-operating – the exact contradictory of Nyaya's scripture and adrsta grounds
- 10 "Jainism is atheistic" misreads the 2019 stem: Jainism denies God, not godhead; and tirthankara is not siddha
- 11 Buddhism denies a CREATOR, not all gods; and the case is not "the Buddha was silent" – it is the krama-akrama dilemma
- 12 a cumulative case is a ROPE, not a chain; and Udayana's list is not a fixed canonical eight with agreed glosses

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 22/22: The answer spine and the qualified conclusion

THE ANSWER SPINE – RUN IT IN THIS ORDER, EVERY TIME

DIRECTIVE decode the verb; make the split visible on the page
PREMISES reconstruct as numbered steps, not narrative
OBJECTION attach each objection to the PREMISE it attacks
REPLY give the proponent's BEST reply, not a straw one
VERDICT grade validity, soundness and adequacy separately; name the criterion
10 marks ~150 words | 15 marks ~220-260 words | 20 marks ~320-360 words

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QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

"The proofs fail as demonstrations but succeed as diagnostics. The ontological argument shows that God, if real, cannot be a contingent item in the world; the cosmological arguments show that contingent reality does not explain itself; the design argument shows that order invites, without compelling, an intentional explanation; the moral argument shows what a serious moral agent must hope; and Nyaya shows that the same inferential path was walked in India, and met the same objections from Mimamsa and Buddhism that Hume and Kant later pressed in Europe. What no proof delivers is the passage from the being it establishes to the God actually worshipped – which is why every tradition eventually supplements proof with experience, testimony or faith."